



Homeowner Remodeling Master Checklist

A one-file overview from early planning through final closeout.

HOMEOWNER RESOURCE

Use this resource to organize decisions and prepare for productive conversations with your contractor, designer and local building department.

Early Planning

- Define the problems the remodel should solve
- Set a comfortable investment range and contingency
- Identify all household decision-makers
- Gather inspiration without selecting products too early
- Confirm property and jurisdiction information

Design & Pricing

- Develop a defined scope and drawings appropriate to the project
- Confirm structural, utility and permit needs
- Compare contractor proposals using the same scope
- Review allowances, exclusions and owner responsibilities
- Confirm long-lead materials before setting expectations

Before Construction

- Complete required permits and approvals
- Approve critical selections and ordering
- Confirm access, protection, hours and communication
- Move valuables and plan temporary routines
- Document existing conditions with photographs

During Construction

- Keep approvals and selections current
- Review written updates and questions promptly
- Document changes before work proceeds
- Respect restricted work areas
- Track inspections and concealed-work photos

Closeout

- Complete a detailed walkthrough
- Confirm corrections and final inspections
- Collect manuals, warranties and finish records
- Organize maintenance information
- Save contracts, changes and project photos

Project Notes

Educational resource only. Costs, schedules, permit requirements and construction methods vary by property, scope and jurisdiction. Confirm project-specific requirements with qualified professionals and the applicable authority.